



**free will
and
determinism**

against
compatibilist
free will

against
incompatibilist
free will

More precisely, our topic is the relationship between freedom of the will and determinism, and a cluster of arguments which seem to show that free will is incompatible with both determinism and indeterminism, and hence impossible.

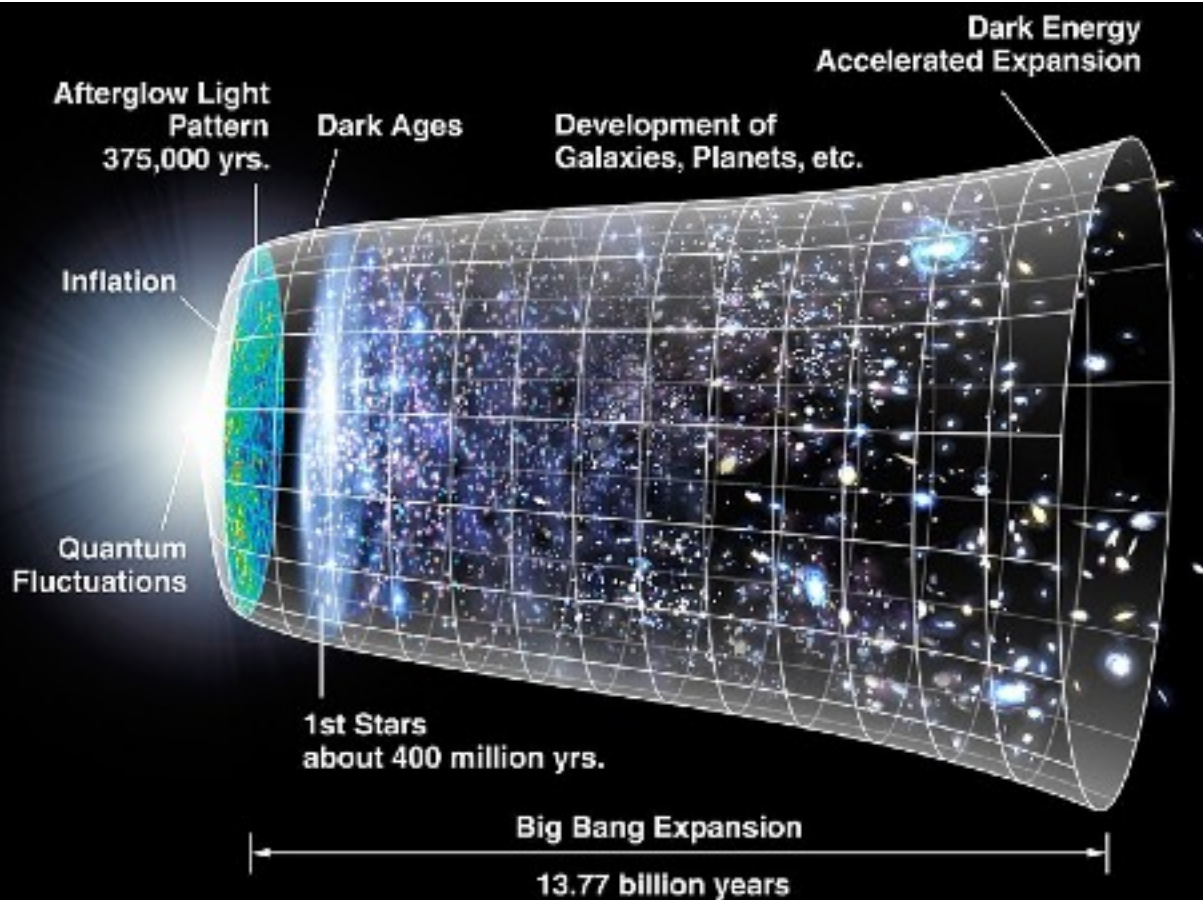
What is 'determinism'?

Consider a timeline of the history of the universe.

What determinism says is that, given a full specification of the state of the universe at one time, the laws of nature tell you exactly what will happen at every later time.

Our topic today is the challenge to free will posed by determinism.

"Determinism is the thesis that only one continuation of the state of things at a given moment is consistent with the laws of nature."



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'Determinism is that only one

ment is not with the law of nature.

containing the state of things at a given



1. No one has any choice about events which

then DECISION happens. (3)



choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

about whether @.

3. If determined, the only one

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

future is not as it was with the state of the

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

of interest.



if P , then Q , then one has any choice

then DECISION. (4,5)

and none has any choice about whether,

varlatatie + the last of the

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

happened in the distant past.

theorie about the fact that if DNR

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

rules out free will.

This argument seems to show that the

combination of four - that No

choice about the laws of nature, then no

one has any choice about the past, no

choice principle, and determinism

Since the first three of these theses

seem quite plausible, the argument

hence that free will is incompatible with

seems to show that if determinism is

true, there are no free actions — and

dearminism.





Wili.

0: There is no fire will.

1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.

2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free





Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks



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reality of free will.

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the



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believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

for (2), and one for (3).

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text 'against compatibilist free will' in white, bold, sans-serif font.

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[REDACTED]

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